

Texas A&M University-Texarkana Course Syllabus

NURS 455

Community Health Nursing



Texas A&M University-Texarkana

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Spring 2025

Texas A&M University-Texarkana
College of Nursing, Health and Human Services
Spring 2025

COURSE NUMBER: NURS 455

COURSE TITLE: Community Health Nursing

COURSE CREDIT: 5 SCH (3 SCH didactic, 2 SCH clinical practicum)

COURSE FACULTY: Erin Hann, MSN Ed, RN
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Office: BASS 328
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Office Hours: Mondays 1200-1400 and Tuesdays 0900-1100
Other office hours by appointment

Appointments with the instructor must be requested through the A&M-Texarkana e-mail account. A pre-scheduled appointment will ensure individual time with faculty as general office hours are open to frequent interruptions and/or other university obligations.

PREREQUISITE: NURS 462, NURS 463, NURS 431

CLASS LOCATION: BASS 245

COURSE DESCRIPTION: This face-to-face course introduces concepts of community health utilizing the population focused nursing process. Emphasis is on health promotion, risk reduction, and disease management in selected community settings. Principles of collaborative care, health disparities, cultural and ethnic differences, genetics, ethics and legal aspects of care, cost, and safety are threaded throughout the course.

TEACHING METHODS: Didactic and Clinical

REQUIRED TEXTS:

Nies, M and McEwen, M. (2023). Community/Public Health Nursing, (8th ed.). Elsevier. ISBN: 9780323829632

New York University Langone Health. (2024, July 13). *City health dashboard*.
<https://www.cityhealthdashboard.com/>

American Psychological Association. (2019). *Concise rules of APA style* (7th ed.). Washington, DC. ISBN – 978-1-4338-32161

American Association of Colleges of Nursing. (2021). *The essentials of baccalaureate education for professional nursing practice*, Washington, DC: AACN. – Free download at <https://www.aacnnursing.org/AACN-Essentials>

American Nurses Association. (2015). *Essentials of nursing practice package* (3rd ed.). Silver Springs MD: ANA. FNDN2015

RECOMMENDED TEXTS: None

TECHNOLOGY REQUIREMENTS: Please visit the information technology website located here: <https://tamut.edu/information-technology/index.html>

STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES (SLO) – Didactic:

By the end of this semester, nursing students will be able to:

1. Utilize patient care and information technology to improve population health outcomes. BE IV; DEC's IVD ;PLO4
2. Collaborate with other health professionals to improve the health of populations BE IV; DEC's IVA ;PLO 2,6
3. Use a population focused, evidence-based nursing process approach to coordinate and plan safe, quality and culturally appropriate nursing interventions for populations. BE III; DEC's IB; IIB PLO 5
4. Coordinate, collaborate, and lead health care teams during local or global emergencies or pandemics to promote community stability, health, safety, and prevent disease. BE VII; DEC's IVG; PLO 7

STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES (SLO) – Clinical:

1. Use information and technology to communicate, manage data, and support decision making to improve population health outcomes.BE;1 DEC's ID,IIA; PLO I
2. Use ethical principles and professional standards in nursing practice to improve population health outcomes SE V;DEC's I.A,III.A; PLO 5
3. Demonstrate therapeutic communication with patients, families, and members of the healthcare team to improve population health outcomes BE VI;DEC's IV.A,IV.B;PLO 6
4. Demonstrate patient-centered care with compassion and coordinated evidence-base practice to improve population health outcomes BE IX; DEC's II.A, II.B; PLO 9
5. Plan evidence-base practice with clinical expertise and patient/family preferences in culturally diverse populations BE IX; DEC's II.D, II.E; PLO 9
6. Formulate ways to minimize risk of harm to patients and staff through both system effectiveness and individual performance.BE IX; DEC's III.B,III.E, PLO9
7. Appraise data to monitor, change outcomes and improve the quality and safety of patient-centered care in culturally diverse populations BE VIII; DEC's ID,PLO 8
8. Demonstrate the ability to apply an experience-based knowledge to practical problems (BE IX; DEC's ID; PLO 9)
9. Make referrals for patients, families, populations, and communities considering care needs, health promotion, maintenance, and restoration. BE VI; DEC's IV-A, IV-C; PLO5

10. Advocate for healthcare policy, finance, and regulatory environments that promote the health of culturally diverse populations. BE5; DEC's IA; IV-B,PLO 5

The *Essentials for Baccalaureate Education for Professional Nursing Practice*, (2021); the *Differentiated Essential Competencies of Graduates of Texas Nursing Programs*, (2021); and the Philosophy of the Division of Nursing provide a foundation for the course objectives.

METHODS OF EVALUATION:

Exams (4).....	50% of grade
Community Assignments	10% of grade
Clinical Grading.....	10% of grade
City Health Dashboard Project.....	5% of grade
Comprehensive Final	25% of grade
Total: 100%	

Grading Scale:

A = 92-100
B = 83-91.9
C = 75-82.9
D = 66-74.9
F = 65 and below

A grade of “C” or above is required in every nursing course. Only one course can be repeated within the baccalaureate nursing program. (See policy in the nursing handbook)

- a. The *weighted average of exam grades* must be 75% for success in the course. Each exam grade will be recorded to the first decimal (example, 82.6). A weighted average of the grades will be determined.
- b. The weighted average of the exam grades must be 75 or higher *without rounding*. For example, a weighted exam average of 74.9 will not be rounded to a 75.
- c. If the weighted exam average meets the standard of 75, then other means of evaluation in the course will be considered in determining the final course grade.
- d. if the weighted exam average does not meet the standard of 75 then no other grades will be considered in determining the grade for the course. The weighted exam average will be submitted as the final course grade.
- e. The weighted exam average will be calculated as follows: 2/3 of unit exams or equivalent and 1/3 of final exam or equivalent.

Competency in dosage calculation will be tested in every clinical course.

1. The content of the test will differ by course, reflecting the population and/or content of the course.
2. The student is allowed two (2) attempts on the test. Failure to achieve the required score after 2 attempts will require that the student withdraw from the course. A grade of “W” will be recorded on the student transcript but will be considered as a failure in the Division of Nursing.
3. A grade of 90% or higher is required to demonstrate competency.

4. The grade on this test will not be included in the calculation of the grade for the course.

COURSE OUTLINE:

Week 1: Health: A Community View; Historical Factors: Public Health Nursing; Population Focused Nursing; Health Promotion and Risk Reduction

Week 2: Epidemiology; Community Assessment; Community Health Planning, Implementation and Evaluation; Education

Week 3: Case Management; Policy, Politics, Legislation; Health Care System

Week 4: Health Care Economics; Cultural diversity and Community Health Nursing; Environmental Health

Week 5: Global Community Health; Child and Adolescent Health; Women's Health

Week 6: Men's Health; Senior Health; Family Health

Week 7: Populations Affected by Disabilities; Veteran's Health; Homelessness

Week 8: Rural and Migrant Health; Populations Affected by Mental Illness

Week 9: Review

Week 10: Communicable Disease, Substance Abuse

Week 11: Violence, Natural and Manmade Disasters

Week 12: School Health; Occupational Health; Forensic and Correctional Nursing

Week 13: Faith Community Nursing; Home Health and Hospice

Week 14: City Health Dashboard Presentations

Week 15: NCLEX Prep

Week 16: Comprehensive Final Exam

FOR EXAM/QUIZ POLICIES, ATTENDANCE POLICIES, ETC REFER TO THE NURSING STUDENT HANDBOOK . (<https://tamut.edu/academic-programs/nursing/files/ug-nursing-student-handbook.pdf>)

STUDENT PARTICIPATION

A. Participation Policy

The student is expected to participate in all activities as assigned by course faculty. Activities may include but are not limited to collaborative projects, reflective activities, library or research components, and any other learning activities as designated by faculty. In courses that require graded in-class activities, these activities are used as a measure of pre-class preparation and post-class learning. Therefore, these activities may not be made up in the event of absence or late entry into class regardless of reason for absence. A grade of zero will be recorded.

B. Course Etiquette

Students are expected to demonstrate professionalism and respect for fellow classmates and the instructor throughout the course by responding in a thoughtful manner that does not criticize or demean anyone in the class.

Late Assignments

Assignments must be submitted on time. If there is an emergency, please notify your instructor as soon as possible. Late submissions will have 5 points per calendar day deducted per faculty discretion. Assignments are due on the assigned date by 11:59 pm.

University Policies

For University policies on [Academic Integrity](#), [A&M-Texarkana Email Address](#), and the [Drop Policy](#), please refer to the [Syllabus Policies](#).

Information Technology (IT) Support

For questions on password reset, login issues, and application installation, please refer to IT Helpdesk or Submit a [TeamDynamix](#) ticket.

Learning Management System (Canvas) Support

For questions on *all web-enhanced and online courses*, please refer to [Technology Innovation and Digital Education \(TIDE\)](#).

Disability Accommodations

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a federal non-discrimination statute that provides comprehensive civil rights protection for persons with disabilities. Among other things, this law requires that all students with disabilities be guaranteed a learning environment that provides for reasonable accommodation of their disabilities. If you believe you have a disability requiring an accommodation, please contact the Office of Student Life in UC room 125, or call (903) 223-1351. For additional information visit [Disability Services](#).

College of Nursing, Health, and Human Services
Division of Nursing
Syllabus Signature Page

I, _____, a nursing student enrolled in NURS 455 Community Health Nursing, acknowledge and accept the following:

- I have received a copy of the syllabus for the above-mentioned course.
- I have read and carefully reviewed the syllabus, and I understand the responsibilities and duties that I, as a student, am called upon to fulfill.
- If I have any questions concerning this syllabus or any of the courses listed above, it is my responsibility to contact my instructor for clarification.
- I understand that I must also be familiar with, and adhere to, the current TAMUT Division of Nursing Student Handbook which addresses the general responsibilities of students. The Nursing Student Handbook clarifies foundational issues related to professional conduct, dress code, grading policies, and other areas that will support my success in the TAMUT Division of Nursing BSN program.
- I have retained a copy of this acknowledgment for my records and have submitted a copy to my faculty member via Canvas.

Signed _____ Date _____